power, and its deployment of harmony (Cui 2013). While the world was under the influence of a global financial crisis, the BRIC countries met at Yekaterinburg (Russia) on June 16, 2009. During the summit meeting, Hu Jintao, the then-China president, proposed a four-point proposal to deal with the financial crisis. They are as below:

- Recovery of the world economy
- Intensifying reform of the international financial system
- Implementing the U.N. Millennium Developmental Goals (MDGs), and
- Ensuring Food Security, energy resources, and public health.[16]

Hu argued that all the BRIC member countries should seize the historic opportunity to strengthen their unity and promote cooperation among their member countries. He also said that BRIC should jointly safeguard the overall interests of developing countries. Similarly, during the second BRICS summit, which was held in Brasilia (Brazil) on April 15, 2010, Hu delivered a speech titled 'cooperation, openness, mutual benefit, and a win–win strategy,' where he underscored that:

> The current international situation is complex, and the global landscape is undergoing profound adjustments. However, no matter how the international system changes, the goal of mutual benefit and the win-win results cannot change. The principle of democracy and fairness cannot change, the direction of mutual respect cannot change, and the spirit of sharing mutual concerns of the people in the same boat cannot change. (Jintao 2010)[17]

Then, the question arises about why China was so optimistic about BRICS at that critical juncture. What made China promote BRICS as a global player?

Why BRICS for China

Yan Wang (2009) said that its influence would grow in the international system despite differences among BRICS members. Scholar Wang Yusheng (2010)[18] observed five glittering points that make China more positive about BRICS.

- All BRICS countries are considered emerging economies and relatively humongous countries, with the fast development, great potential, and